

Siding with the giants

Pros

1. Easier to set up shop

One advantage with big online retailers is that it's relatively easy for you to start a business. You can think of it as the virtual equivalent of a plug-and-play office space.

Also, these websites have had some amount of experience with selling products online. Based on their past learning, they continually optimise the design and layout of the website so that the customer can trace out the required product with minimal effort and the buying process is smooth.

There are also other aspects which make it easy for you to set up shop with a big retailer. For one thing, you have the option for freight tracking and also access to the statistics on the web traffic. Also, the payment process is all set.

2. Preexisting customer trust

These days, it's not uncommon to hear businessmen say how they have to spend more money on marketing and support activities to build customer trust than how much they spend to actually manufacture their products.

In this context, the fact that with big online retailers, the customer trust factor is a given is a huge advantage. A whole lot of branding and business development effort has already gone into the platform by the time you start your business with them. The customers already have a trust on the quality of products that they sell, and also on their delivery mechanism. This means that you get the twin advantage of a higher viewership and better marketing from day one.

3. Instant support system

Aside from the support that they provide their customers, the big online retailers also have support system in place for the sellers on their platform. Also, there's a community of sellers already on board these platforms.

This means that if you have doubts or queries regarding the best practices to move your product, or what kind of products you should put online seasonally, you have a huge knowledge pool to draw from. What's more, some of these connections that you make with your fellow-sellers could lead to fruitful marketing partnerships in the future.

4. Ability to sell in a wider market

Big online retailers like Amazon have established themselves in multiple